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Using Analogous and Hyphenated Codes

Rating a disability by analogy is an uncommon occurrence, but an RVSR, you will occasionally encounter situations that require you to do so.

Using Analogous Codes

Use analogous codes to evaluate disabilities not listed in the *Schedule for Rating Disabilities* based on

- function(s) affected
- anatomical location, and
- symptomatology

Components of an Analogous Code

An analogous code consists of two diagnostic codes (DCs) separated by a hyphen. The *first* DC of an analogous code is a four-digit code as follows:

- the first two digits refer to the body system involved in the rating, and
- the second two digits are always 99.

The *second* DC of an analogous code is composed of a four-digit code that

- is taken from the Schedule for Rating Disabilities, and
- identifies the criteria used to evaluate the claimed disability.

Notes:

- DCs ending in "99" are not acceptable except when the disability is hyphenated as in 6699-6603.
- A DC may not end in 99 unless
 - o it is the *first* four digit code in an analogous code, or
 - o service connection (SC) for the disability has been denied *and* it has not been evaluated for pension.

Example: Use 6599-6516 for postoperative tonsillectomy if the condition is evaluated under the criteria for chronic laryngitis.

Using Hyphenated Codes to Rate Residual Conditions

Hyphenated codes do *not* necessarily denote analogous ratings. A hyphenated DC may be used to identify the proper evaluation of a disability or a residual from disease.



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The *first* DC of a hyphenated code identifies the diagnosed disease or condition. The *second* DC of a hyphenated code identifies the criteria in the *Schedule for Rating Disabilities* used to evaluate the disability.

Example: Ankylosis of the wrist from rheumatoid arthritis would be rated as 5002-5214.

Rating Multiple Disabling Manifestations From the Same Disease

When rating multiple disabling manifestations resulting from the same disease, such as arthritis, multiple sclerosis, or cerebrovascular accident, code each disability separately as follows:

- show the DC of the disease as the lead DC of the hyphenated codes
- follow the lead code with a code for the body system of the most severely affected disorder
- code the involvement of the other body systems under the DC for the disability on which the evaluation is determined, and
- identify the basic disease entity in the diagnoses of the disabilities involved.

Example: Multiple disabling manifestations of Parkinson's disease (DC 8004) would result in the following hyphenated codes:

- 8004-8520 sciatic nerve condition due to Parkinson's disease as the most severely affected residual, followed by less disabling residuals of
- 8515 median nerve condition due to Parkinson's disease
- 9434 major depressive disorder due to Parkinson's disease, and
- 7203 esophageal stricture due to Parkinson's disease.